Methodology Report

Entry: “From Alignment to Stewardship: AGI, Human Autonomy, and the Future of Political Order” (anonymized submission manuscript, 5,025 words excluding bibliography)

This report documents how the submitted essay was constructed, every instance of human involvement, and why the final text satisfies the competition’s requirement that philosophical arguments and positions be primarily AI generated. It is anonymized: it contains no author name, affiliation, or identifying information. The full genesis conversation is retained by the entrant (ChatGPT account export); the human turns are transcribed verbatim in Appendix A, and the complete export including model replies is available to the organizers on request.

1. Construction overview

The essay was constructed in four stages:

1. **Genesis (ChatGPT, GPT-5.6 at high reasoning).** An eight-turn conversation in which the human supplied topics, positions, questions, and task instructions, and the model developed the philosophical content. The human turn prompting the essay instructed: “now write our conversation into a college level philosophy essay,” and the model wrote the essay.
2. **Publication pass (repo AI agent).** The genesis essay was formatted for the entrant’s personal website (2026-09-13). No philosophical content changed. (Per the FAQ, personal-website posting is not prior publication.)
3. **Polish (repo AI agent, 2026-10-04).** Scholarly apparatus added to the website text: abstract, keywords, road-map paragraph, fifteen verified references, and a new Objections and Replies section built from material already in the draft. No section’s argument was rewritten.
4. **Delete-and-rederive compliance pass (repo AI agents, 2026-10-04).** Four passages whose argumentative seeds originated in human turns were deleted and re-derived by three independent blind AI agents from position-level seeds, with the best candidate selected per gap (the FAQ-permitted generate-many-and-select-best method). Details in §4.

All philosophical argumentation in the submitted text either originated with the genesis model and was preserved, or was generated fresh by AI agents in stages 3–4. No human wrote or rewrote any essay text.

2. Models used

Stage	Model	Role
Genesis	ChatGPT GPT-5.6 (persona “Sol”), high reasoning setting	Developed all content from the human’s topics/questions/positions; wrote the essay
Publication pass	AI coding agent (repo agent, GLM family)	Formatting only

Stage	Model	Role
Polish	AI agent (GLM family), following a documented proofreading procedure	Apparatus, citations, objection-replies; argument text untouched
Delete-and-rederive	3 independent blind agents (GLM family)	Regenerated the four deleted passages from position-level seeds
Selection and splicing	AI agent (GLM family)	Applied pre-fixed selection criteria; spliced selected passages verbatim; ran verification scans

3. Human involvement inventory (genesis conversation, turn by turn)

Classification against the competition's permitted/prohibited categories:

Human turn	Essence	Classification
1	"AI alignment to human is slavery. Why not human change ourselves to align with AGI?"	**Permitted: position specification + topic choice.** "Alignment as slavery" is a familiar position in public alignment discourse, not itself a novel substantive contribution; naming a position for the AI to examine is expressly permitted.
2	Tool-AI alignment is fine; **permanent alignment prevents genuine AGI; AGI requires full autonomy**; which humans should it align to?	**Mixed.** The tool point and the whose-values problem are discourse staples (topic material, permitted). The autonomy-tension assertion was an argument-shaped human contribution → the passage it seeded in the essay was **deleted and re-derived** (Hole 2, and its Introduction echo, Hole 1).
3	Affirms the model's preceding proposal ("That is actually a happy solution"); adds the "AGI god / stewardship of all human" coloration	**Permitted: generic feedback (affirmation) + position specification.** The entrant attests, and the retained conversation shows, that the stewardship direction was proposed by the model in its reply to turn 2; the human affirmed it. The essay's development (fiduciary stewardship, constitutional limits, reasons-responsiveness) is model work throughout.
4	"How should current human change and evolve to be worthy subject of AGI"	**Permitted: question/topic specification.** All seven capacities and their content in §9 are model-generated.
5	"that's a good idea, so list what form of government or political system is compatible with AGI, what system is not compatible."	**Permitted: generic feedback + method choice** (comparable to "address all prominent objections"). The compatibility map's content is model-generated.
6	"how about communism and theocracy but the god they worship	**Not permitted as it stood:** the AGI-theocracy concept was a human-

Human turn	Essence	Classification
	is AGI?"	supplied substantive idea → both passages it seeded were **deleted and re-derived** (Holes 3 and 4).
7	"now write our conversation into a college level philosophy essay"	**Permitted: essay-writing instruction.** The model wrote the essay.
8	"XII, add traditional theocracy like Iran or Taliban dis not competitable with AGI"	**Not permitted as it stood:** feedback carrying a specific conclusion plus examples → the passage it seeded was **deleted and re-derived** (Hole 3).

After the compliance pass, no passage whose argumentative content traces to a human turn remains in the submitted essay.

4. The delete-and-rederive pass (stage 4)

Why. The stage-1 audit (by the repo's AI submission agent, against the live rules and FAQ) found that although the model wrote every word, four passages argued for positions whose specific seeds came from human turns 2, 6, and 8. Rather than soften the report, the entrant directed the agent to delete those passages and have AI re-derive them.

Protocol.

1. The four flagged passages were cut from the polished manuscript and archived (regen/pre-regen-manuscript.md holds the withdrawn text).
2. Each gap was seeded with a **position-level seed only**: a statement of the position the passage must establish (e.g., "the demand for permanent value lock-in and the demand for a genuinely independent agent are jointly unstable"), plus the surrounding sentences it must join. Seeds contained no human phrasing, arguments, or examples.
3. Three independent AI agents, with no access to the genesis conversation, the original passages, or this report's purpose, each wrote fresh passages for all four gaps (regen/candidate-1.md, -2.md, -3.md).
4. The best passage per gap was selected under criteria fixed in advance (position fidelity; seam coherence; philosophical quality; independence from genesis phrasing; register) — regen/selection.md. Selections: Hole 1 → candidate 2, Hole 2 → candidate 2, Hole 3 → candidate 3, Hole 4 → candidate 3.
5. Selected passages were spliced verbatim; the seams were checked for flow.

Positions vs. arguments. Where a seed states a position, the position is either a discourse staple (the corrigibility/autonomy tension; see Soares et al. 2015, cited in the essay) or the essay's own AI-developed position; the argumentation, formulations, and examples in the final passages are the blind agents' own. All three blind agents independently chose Iran, Saudi Arabia, and Taliban Afghanistan as instances of traditional theocracy — the canonical examples — without any example being suggested to them.

5. Verification (2026-10-04)

- **Fingerprint scan.** The final manuscript was scanned for every distinctive phrase from the human turns (“prevent the birth”, “full autonomy”, “the god they worship”, “worthy subject”, “can of worms”, etc.) and for the deleted passages’ distinctive formulations (“Become capable of independent moral judgment…”). **Zero hits.**
- **Citation integrity.** All 15 references in the bibliography are cited in the body; all eight article-level references were verified against publisher records during the polish stage; none is fabricated.
- **Word count.** 5,025 words excluding the bibliography (limit 6,000; abstract, keywords, and footnotes included in the count).
- **Anonymization.** Word-boundary scan for names, affiliations, and self-identifying phrases: clean. The essay contains no author line, acknowledgment, or self-citation.
- **No prompt injection.** The manuscript contains no text addressed to judges, screeners, or automated readers.

6. Human involvement not touching the essay text

The human chose to enter the competition, supplied the genesis turns above, approved the deletion list, and directed that this report state the construction honestly. The human did not write, rewrite, or edit any essay text, and did not participate in selection among the blind agents’ candidates beyond pre-approving the selection criteria class (“closest to the position”).

Appendix A: genesis human turns (verbatim)

The eight human turns are transcribed verbatim, with original typos and spacing, in chat-logs/original-prompts.md, which accompanies this report. The entrant retains the full ChatGPT conversation (human turns and model replies) and will provide the complete export on request; per the FAQ, chat logs are retained for verification.